poor and formerly colonized countries, primarily in Asia, but increasingly all over the world. India was one of the founding members of the United Nations, in 1945, even before Independence and played a critical role throughout the era of decolonization.

In recent years, Indian activism in the UN has focused on seeking change in the composition of the Security Council to reflect contemporary global power realities. At the time of the UN's creation, it might have made sense to give a veto to only five major powers. The United States, the Soviet Union, Britain, France and China were allies during the Second World War and, having defeated the Axis powers, were expected to be the key arbiters of global security. Much has changed since that time, however. Russia no longer wields power similar to that of the Soviet Union while Britain and France have diminished in stature. India along with Brazil, Germany and Japan is part of the group of four nations
(G-4) that see themselves as worthy of permanent membership in an expanded Security Council.

Apart from demanding reform of the Security Council, India is currently also one of the major contributors of troops for UN peacekeeping missions around the world. India prefers not to station its forces outside its territory except as part of a UN peacekeeping force. Over the decades around 180,000 Indian troops have served as UN peacekeepers. India has participated in forty-four of the sixty-nine UN peacekeeping missions mandated by the UN and 156 Indian peacekeepers have been killed while serving the United Nations.[28]

A similar activism characterizes India's role in global financial institutions. India has been a member of International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), known as the World Bank, since its creation in 1945. One of the twenty-five executive directors on the World Bank board is from India. For years, India was among the World Bank's leading borrowers, utilizing loans for infrastructure development such as